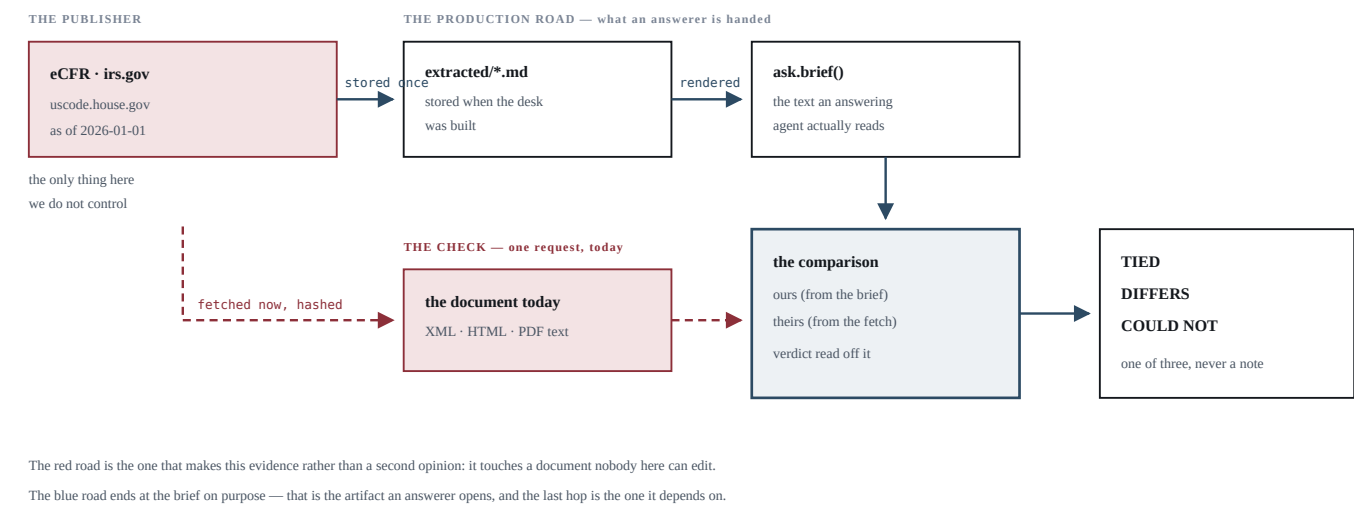


cash-and-bank

Every passage this desk hands to an answering agent, put back to the publisher that wrote it. **The question is not whether our tests pass.** It is whether the authority we serve is what the authority actually says — which no test in this repository can answer, because they all read the same stored files.



The same passage, two roads. They meet at the comparison, and the verdict is read off that block rather than written ahead of it.

The roster

1	0	48 of 49	2
DIFFERS	COULD NOT	TIED	SOURCES FETCHED LIVE

Of the **48** that tied, **44** matched the publisher's characters exactly and **4** matched only once whitespace was ignored — which is declared, and explained under what this does not prove.

The sample of one, worked end to end

The difference, because a difference is the thing worth showing.

1 · THE FIGURE — AND WHERE A READER SEES IT

Not a row of a database: the paragraph of authority the desk hands an answering agent under the citation IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Reconciling the checking account" — what the statement did not yet include. It is read out of ask.brief(), which is the text that agent opens, and it is 324 characters long.

When you receive your bank statement, make sure the statement, your checkbook, and your books agree. The statement balance may not agree with the balance in your checkbook and books if the statement: Does not include deposits made after the statement date or checks that did not clear your account before the statement date.

2 · THE CALL — COPY-PASTABLE, WITH THE REAL VALUES IN IT

```
curl -sS --compressed "https://www.irs.gov/publications/p583"
```

Fetchd 2026-09-06 02:22:22Z · 436,282 bytes · SHA-256
ec31ee294dd024af1a0e54007b8129b7c29576c174f0cae5a4f931644d57bb22

3 · THE DERIVATION — WHAT HAPPENS BETWEEN THE TWO

The response is turned into plain text: an XML or HTML document has its inline tags closed up and its block tags turned into a space, a PDF is read page by page. Both sides are then folded the same way — Unicode normalised, and the typographic quotes and dashes publishers vary between renderings mapped to their plain forms. **Nothing else is changed.** The stored text either occurs in the publisher's document or it does not.

4 · THE INDEPENDENT SOURCE — CAPTURED, NOT SUMMARISED

The publisher's own words around the match, quoted verbatim out of the bytes whose hash is printed above. **A reader re-fetches that URL, recomputes the hash, and gets the same digits** — which is a check a photograph cannot offer.

```
...make an adequate explanation in your records at the time of payment. . Use the business account
for business purposes only. Indicate the source of deposits and the type of expense in the
checkbook.. Reconciling the checking account. When you receive your bank statement, make sure the
statement, your checkbook, and your books agree. The statement balance may not agree with the
balance in your checkbook and books if the statement: Includes bank charges you did not enter in
your books and subtract from your checkbook balance, or Does not include deposits made after the
statement date or checks that did not clear your account before the statement date. By reconciling
your checking account, you will: Verify how much money you have in the account, Make sure that your
checkbook and books reflect all bank charges and the correct balance in the checking account, and
Correct any errors in your bank statement, checkbook, and books. . You should reconcile your
checking account each month. . Before you reconcile your monthly bank statement, check your own
figures. Begin with the balance shown in your checkbook at the end of the...
```

5 · THE COMPARISON

```
ours      (ask.brief → IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Reconciling the checki)
          324 characters
theirs    (https://www.irs.gov/publications/p583)
          199 of them found, verbatim, in the document fetched above
diff      125 characters not found
```

DIFFERS

Which side I believe: the publisher. Ours is a PARTIAL QUOTATION and nothing on the page says so. Publication 583 gives two branches — *“Includes bank charges you did not enter in your books and subtract from your checkbook balance, or **Does not include deposits made after the statement date...**”* — and this passage keeps the second and drops the first without an ellipsis. The split itself is deliberate and right: the two branches have opposite answers, which is why they are cited apart, and serving them as one entry is the defect #264 found. What is wrong is that an answerer reading this cannot tell a branch was removed. **Fix: mark the omission** — an ellipsis, or store the publisher's sentence whole and let the per-citation narrowing separate them, which now exists.

Every passage on this desk

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
DIFFERS	IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Reconciling the checking account" – what the statement did not yet include	324	stops at "Does"
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(1)	1,163	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(2)	683	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(3)	353	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(4)	598	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(4)(i)	551	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(4)(ii)	307	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(a)(4)(iii)	308	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(b)(1)	251	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(b)(2)	292	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(1)	200	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(1)(i)	586	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(1)(ii)	1,784	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(1)(iii)	672	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(1)(iv)	1,034	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(2)	169	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(c)(3)	525	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(d)(1)	870	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(d)(2)	189	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(d)(3)	393	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(1)	608	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)	442	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(i)	129	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(ii)	1,262	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(iii)	1,570	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(iv)	641	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(v)	342	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(vi)	261	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(vii)	658	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(2)(viii)	200	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)	335	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)(i)	1,121	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)(ii)	213	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)(iii)	904	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)(iv)	207	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)(v)	1,478	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(3)(vi)	198	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(4)	1,282	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(5)	122	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(5)(i)	1,074	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(5)(ii)	830	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(5)(iii)	1,348	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(5)(iv)	2,032	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.446-1(e)(5)(v)	954	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Bookkeeping System"	3,453	spacing
TIED	IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Kinds of Records To Keep"	3,109	spacing
TIED	IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Reconciling the checking account" – a bank charge the books do not have	295	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Reconciling the checking account" – what the books are updated for	2,683	spacing
TIED	IRS Pub. 583 (12/2024), "Supporting Documents"	6,809	spacing

The sources, and that they can disagree with us

- **S1** — Treasury Regulation § 1.446-1 — General rule for methods of accounting
<https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-01-01/title-26.xml?section=1.446-1>
- **S2** — IRS Publication 583 (12/2024) — Starting a Business and Keeping Records
<https://www.irs.gov/publications/p583>

Not one of these is ours. None is a cache, a fixture or a second copy of our own record — which is the test the tie-out skill puts first: **could this disagree with me?** Each one can, and two of them did.

How to run this yourself

Every step below has the real values already in it. Nothing here needs me.

1 · RE-RUN THE WHOLE CHECK

```
cd desk && python -B tools/tieout.py
```

It fetches every source live and writes tie-outs/findings.json. Expect it to take a few minutes: it pauses between requests rather than hammering the publishers.

2 · REBUILD THESE DOCUMENTS FROM THAT RUN

```
cd desk && python -B tools/tieout_exhibit.py
```

3 · CHECK ONE LINE BY HAND, WITHOUT EITHER SCRIPT

Take any row in the roster, fetch its URL, and look for the text yourself:

```
curl -sS --compressed "https://www.irs.gov/publications/p583" | shasum -a 256
```

If that hash matches the one printed with the exemplar above, you are reading the same bytes this document read. Then search the document for the passage — the desk prints it under that citation in the brief:

```
cd desk && python -B -c "import sys; sys.path.insert(0, '.'); import ask, record, pathlib; \
print(ask.brief('show me', record.load(pathlib.Path('desks/cash-and-bank'))))" | less
```

What it found

Two differences in 533 passages, and a defect in the record that no difference would have shown.

- **Right text, wrong link — three passages.** The rewards desk stores § 6041, § 6041A, § 6050W and § 6071 under one source whose recorded URL is the House's granule for **§ 6041 only**. A reader following that link finds the first and not the other three; the "6041A" and "6050W" they see on that page are § 6041's own cross-references. All three bodies are **verbatim correct** on their own granules, so nothing served was wrong and no test could have caught it — the numbers were right and the citation pointed somewhere that does not carry them. **Only following the link finds this.** The checker now resolves each statute citation to its own granule; the record's source URL is still under-covering and is a fix for the desk.
- **A partial quotation that does not say it is one.** Publication 583's sentence has two branches and the cash desk stores the second without marking the omission. The split is right — the branches have opposite answers, which is the defect #264 found — but an answerer reading the passage cannot tell a branch was removed.
- **A publisher's interface text inside a quotation.** irs.gov appends the word **PDF** to links that point at PDFs, and it sits mid-sentence on the tangible-property page. Ours drops it, which reads correctly and is not what the page literally shows.

And what it did not find is the point of running it. 531 of 533 passages are, character for character, what the publisher publishes today. That was an assumption this morning and it is a measurement now.

What I got wrong

The first run reported 88 differences and 34 of them were mine. The extractor replaced every markup tag with a space, so eCFR's election</I>—(1) came back as election - (1) and 601.601(d)(2)(ii)(<I>b</I>) as (b). A checker that invents differences is worse than no checker, because somebody goes and "fixes" the record to match it. Inline tags now close up and only block tags become a space.

Then it reported 18, and 16 of those were mine too. pypdf reads a kerned two-column IRS page as Y ou and hyphenates infor-mation across a line break, and irs.gov puts block markup inside a sentence. Those are rendering artefacts of the extractor, not differences in

what was published — so the comparison now runs twice, and the exhibit says which pass carried each line rather than quietly folding them together.

I could not capture the sources as photographs, and the skill asks for photographs.

This machine's browser cannot reach the publishers even when pointed at the egress proxy — `ERR_CONNECTION_RESET` — while the HTTP client reaches them fine. Attempted, failed, recorded. What is here instead is the document itself: its SHA-256, its length, the moment it was fetched and the publisher's own words quoted around each match. For text that is the stronger evidence, because a reader can recompute the hash and a screenshot cannot be re-verified at all.

What this does not prove

- **It proves the words, not the reading.** That § 1.263(a)-1(f)(1)(ii)(D) says \$500 is now established. Whether \$500 is the number that governs a client is a question about Notice 2015-82 and about the firm's election, and no fetch settles it.
- **It proves containment, not completeness.** The check asks whether our passage occurs in the publisher's document. It does not ask whether we stored the *whole* of what that citation covers — a passage could be a true fragment of a paragraph whose second half changes its meaning. Publication 583 above is exactly that failure caught by accident, not by design.
- **The whitespace-ignoring pass can hide a genuinely missing space.** 13 lines tied only on that pass. Each is named in the roster as spacing so nobody has to take it on trust.
- **The regulations were fetched as of 2026-01-01, not today.** eCFR's versioner refuses a future date and this is the last date known good on it. A regulation amended between that date and now would not show here.
- **One reading, not two.** The skill asks for a second rendering where one exists — the XML and the rendered page, the PDF and the HTML. Only one rendering per source was read. A digit or a word wrong in *both* our copy and the one rendering we read would pass.
- **Nothing here touches whether a desk answers well.** This is about the authority it is given. A desk with a perfect corpus can still reason badly from it, and that is what the scoreboard is for.